

What Do You Know About Your Rights at Work?

You work here starting today — or you have for years. Either way, this course puts the policies you need in plain language. By the end, you will know exactly what to do and who to call in any situation.

What We Will Cover Together

1	**Module 1** Your employment relationship and who is protected
2	**Module 2** Harassment, discrimination, retaliation, and how to report
3	**Module 3** Pay, classification, timekeeping, and conduct
4	**Module 4** Safety, time off, and your legal rights





Employment At-Will — What It Means for You

At J. F. Pennebaker Co., employment is at-will: either you or the company may end the relationship at any time, with or without cause, with or without notice.

No manager, handbook language, or verbal promise can change that.

Only **ONE exception exists**: a signed written agreement made by the CEO or President. If no one handed you that document, you are at-will.

The Handbook Is Not a Contract

This handbook is a set of guidelines — it is not a promise of employment for any set period.

The company may update policies at any time. Written changes will be shared with all employees.

Verbal statements cannot alter what is written here.





Who Is Protected Here

The company is an equal opportunity employer. Every employment decision is based on merit.

Protected categories include: race, color, religion, national origin, sex (including pregnancy, sexual orientation, and gender identity), age 40 or older, disability, genetic information, military or veteran status, and more.

Association counts too: discrimination based on your connection to someone in a protected category is also prohibited.

Pay discrimination is prohibited. You may lawfully discuss your wages with coworkers.



Your First Point of Contact

For any policy question, concern, or accommodation request, reach out to:

Melissa Massey

m.massey@johnpennebaker.com

678-546-8858

Who the Anti-Harassment Policy Covers

This policy covers everyone in the workplace environment.

Employees, supervisors, managers, vendors, customers, contractors, and other third parties — all of them.

Applicants, unpaid interns, and volunteers are protected too.

No one is outside this policy.



Two Types of Sexual Harassment — Know the Difference

Quid pro quo

A benefit is offered or a threat is made in exchange for sexual attention.

Examples: offering better shifts for sexual favors; threatening termination for refusing an advance.

Hostile work environment

Unwelcome conduct based on a protected class that is severe or pervasive enough to affect working conditions.

Examples: slurs, offensive jokes, unwanted touching, derogatory images or gestures.

Note: sexual harassment does not require sexual motivation — hostile conduct based on gender alone violates policy.

Retaliation Is Prohibited

Reporting discrimination, harassment, suspected fraud, or unethical conduct is protected.

Participating in an investigation is protected.

The company will not tolerate retaliation from any source — managers, coworkers, or third parties.

One limit: knowingly filing a false, bad-faith report is not protected conduct.



How to Report a Concern

Go to your direct supervisor, any member of management, or Melissa Massey.

If your complaint involves your direct supervisor, skip that person and go directly to another manager or Melissa Massey.

Be as detailed as possible: describe what happened, who was involved, and who witnessed it.

Written complaints are preferred but not required.

Investigations are thorough, objective, and kept confidential to the extent possible.

Melissa Massey — Report Here

To report any concern or file a complaint, contact:

Melissa Massey

m.massey@johnpennebaker.com

678-546-8858



Requesting an Accommodation

Need an adjustment for a disability, pregnancy, or religious belief? Contact Melissa Massey — written requests are preferred.

The company engages in a two-way interactive process to find a workable solution.

Under the federal Pregnant Workers Fairness Act, leave is not automatically required if another reasonable accommodation is available.

No one will be retaliated against for requesting an accommodation.

GINA reminder: do not share family medical history or genetic test results when responding to any company medical information request.



Scenario Drill — Module 2 Activity

You have just learned about quid pro quo harassment, hostile work environment harassment, and retaliation.

Your instructor is ready to walk through some real-world situations with you.

Ask your instructor to run the scenario drill when you are ready to begin.

You will identify what type of situation is described and say what you would do next.

Your Employment Classification

Full-Time Non-Exempt

40 or more hours per week — eligible for overtime and company benefits.

Part-Time Non-Exempt

Fewer than 40 hours per week — eligible for overtime, generally no company benefits.

Temporary

Hired for a specific task — no company benefits, does not convert to full-time by passage of time.

Exempt

Salaried, meets federal and state exemption criteria — not eligible for overtime, receives company benefits.

Your classification determines your overtime eligibility and your access to benefits.

Overtime, Timekeeping, and the Workweek

The fixed workweek is 168 consecutive hours — workweeks cannot be averaged together.

Non-exempt employees must record all hours worked. Working off the clock is never permitted, for any reason.

Exempt employees receive a salary. If you believe a deduction was made in error, report it — the company has a safe harbor policy to correct improper deductions.

Nursing employees: the company provides reasonable break time and a private, non-bathroom space to express milk.



Conduct, Confidentiality, and Company Systems

Be at your assigned work area, ready to work, when your shift starts. Notify your supervisor as early as possible if you will be late or absent.

Company computers, email, and communications tools are not private. The company may monitor them at any time. Use them for business purposes.

Protect company information during and after your employment — the confidentiality obligation does not end when you leave.

Conflicts of interest must be disclosed. When in doubt about any conduct, ask your supervisor or Melissa Massey.





Your NLRA Rights — These Cannot Be Taken Away

Section 7 of the National Labor Relations Act gives you the right to discuss wages, hours, and working conditions with coworkers.

You may engage in protected concerted activity.

Nothing in the handbook removes these rights. They belong to you regardless of any other policy.

Classification Activity — Module 3

Tell your instructor your employment classification.

Your instructor will confirm whether you are eligible for overtime, company benefits, or both — and explain what that means for your day-to-day timekeeping.

Ask your instructor to walk through it with you now.



Safety Rules You Must Follow

Drug and alcohol policy

Report for work fit for duty. Impairment is not permitted on the job.

Smoke-free workplace

Smoking and tobacco use are prohibited in all company facilities and vehicles.

Workplace violence and bullying

Prohibited and must be reported immediately.

Work-related injuries

All work-related injuries must be reported to your supervisor promptly, no matter how minor they seem.

Company property inspections

The company may inspect company property — vehicles, equipment, and workspaces — at any time.

Time Off and Leave at a Glance

Available leave includes: company holidays, vacation (note: unused vacation is not paid out upon separation), military leave under USERRA, jury duty leave, witness leave, voting leave, and other approved leaves of absence.

Your eligibility depends on your employment classification.

Temporary and part-time employees generally do not receive company benefits except where law requires.



Rights the Handbook Cannot Restrict

You may report concerns to any government agency at any time without fear of retaliation.

You retain full Section 7 NLRA rights: discuss wages, hours, and working conditions freely and engage in concerted activity.

These protections belong to every employee, in every classification, on every day of employment.



Optional Knowledge Check

A brief knowledge check is available to help you confirm what you have learned across all four modules.

Topics include classification, reporting procedures, harassment types, and safety rules.

It is optional and completely private — nothing is recorded.

Ask your instructor to start the knowledge check when you are ready.





You Are Ready — Here Is What to Do Next

Thank you for completing the J. F. Pennebaker Co. Employee Handbook course.

Your next step: acknowledge the handbook as directed by your supervisor or HR.

Any question at any time — contact Melissa Massey:

Melissa Massey

m.massey@johnpennebaker.com

678-546-8858